

Task 4 – Severity & Case Classification

Pharmacovigilance Internship Submission

Case 1: Non-serious and Expected

Patient Information

Patient: Female, 30 years

Diagnosis: Acute bacterial sinusitis

Suspected Drug: Amoxicillin 500 mg orally three times daily

Adverse Reaction: Mild generalized skin rash and itching

Management: Amoxicillin discontinued; antihistamine administered

Outcome: Complete recovery within 3 days

Reference Safety Information: Skin rash and hypersensitivity reactions are described in the established safety information

Classification:

Parameter	Assessment
Severity	Mild
Seriousness	Non-serious
Seriousness criterion	None met; no death, life-threatening event, hospitalization, disability, congenital anomaly or medically important event
Expectedness	Expected
Clinical impact	Low

Assessment:

The reaction was mild and resolved after treatment was stopped. It did not result in hospitalization or another serious outcome criterion. The reaction is considered expected because it is consistent with the stated safety information.

Conclusion:

Final Classification: Non-serious, mild, and expected A

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Case 2: Serious and Expected

Patient Information

Patient: Male, 58 years

Diagnosis: Atrial fibrillation

Suspected Drug: Warfarin, dose adjusted according to anticoagulation monitoring

Adverse Reaction: Gastrointestinal bleeding

Management: Warfarin withheld and patient admitted to hospital for treatment and monitoring

Outcome: Recovered after hospital treatment

Reference Safety Information: Bleeding is an established adverse reaction associated with warfarin therapy

Classification:

Parameter	Assessment
Severity	Severe
Seriousness	Serious
Seriousness criterion	Inpatient hospitalization
Expectedness	Expected
Clinical impact	Significant

Assessment:

The event was severe in intensity and required inpatient hospitalization. Hospitalization meets a regulatory seriousness criterion. Bleeding is an established risk of warfarin therapy, so the reaction is considered expected in this mock case.

Conclusion:

Final Classification: Serious, severe, and expected ADR

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Case 3: Serious and Unexpected

Patient Information

Patient: Female, 46 years

Diagnosis: Hyperlipidemia

Suspected Drug: A hypothetical investigational lipid-lowering medicine, Drug X

Adverse Reaction: Severe hepatic injury requiring hospitalization

Management: Drug X discontinued; patient admitted for evaluation and supportive treatment

Outcome: Patient recovered after treatment

Reference Safety Information: Available safety information describes mild, transient liver-enzyme elevations but does not describe severe hepatic injury requiring hospitalization

Classification:

Parameter	Assessment
Severity	Severe
Seriousness	Serious
Seriousness criterion	Inpatient hospitalization
Expectedness	Unexpected
Clinical impact	Significant

Assessment:

The reaction required inpatient hospitalization and is therefore serious. It is severe in intensity because it involved significant hepatic injury. Although mild liver-enzyme elevations are described in the available safety information, severe hepatic injury requiring hospitalization is not described; therefore, the reaction is considered unexpected for this mock case.

Conclusion:

Final Classification: Serious, severe, and unexpected ADR

Overall Conclusion:

The three mock cases demonstrate how adverse drug reactions can be classified according to severity, seriousness, and expectedness. The cases also show that severity and seriousness are different concepts: severity refers to intensity, while seriousness depends on defined outcomes or clinical criteria.

Key Learning Point:

A proper case assessment should separately evaluate the intensity of the reaction, whether a seriousness criterion is met, and whether the event is consistent with the relevant safety information.